

Ecovotive Chimeras

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Abstract

The project begins with the first ten images retrieved from Google Search of wild animals burned in wildfires across severely affected regions. From these, three chimeras emerge in each of the five continents, from biomes most impacted by fire in North America, South America, Africa, Asia, and Australia, through a process of melting carbonized remains into one another via AI. The algorithmically ranked images—already filtered through machinic logic—are processed through a sequence of generative systems: starting with AI-generated animations created from appropriated photographic material and short text prompts, decomposed into video frames, and then transformed into three-dimensional hybrid forms through AI-based 3D reconstruction. These resulting entities—chimeric, spectral, and ontologically unstable—are materialized via 3D printing in white PLA and accompanied by augmented reality (AR) layers that reveal their internal, data-driven mutations. The bizarre logic of generative AI aesthetics—marked by hallucinated forms, melted boundaries, blurred textures, and indeterminate shapes—becomes a critical dialogue with the visual and biological trauma of wildfire destruction. The dramatic abstraction in generative outputs mirrors the devastation in ecologies like the Amazon biome, Brazil’s wetlands, California, the Republic of Congo, Australia, Mongolia, and beyond. The audience is invited to hold these hybrid beings, feel their fragility, and enter—via AR—a liminal zone where emergence, agency, and entropy converge—an ephemeral retreat of continuous becoming

CCS Concepts

• computing; • Arts and humanities; • Media arts;

Keywords

Generative AI, Digital Fabrication, Augmented Reality, Post-Human Ecologies

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1 Introduction

Ecovotive Chimeras embodies an exploratory methodology that engages with human-induced environmental destruction [Barnes et al., 2024] through a dynamic, meditative process that both critiques and remakes the remains of these tragic events into semiotic translations [Jakobson, 2000]. Central to this exploration is the use of generative AI tools to transmute the tangible traces of such tragedies. The installation consists of fifteen small, 3D-printed chimeric creatures (200 mm × 200 mm × 150 mm), generated through AI processes using as the initial input, photographic documentation of carbonized wildlife victims from wildfire-prone biomes across five continents.

2 methodology

Inspired by the votive function of animals [Ikran, 2017] in ancient cultures [Gauge et al., 2018]—where ecologies were lived as cosmologies—each PLA-printed form (Figure 1) is augmented with AR layers that animate a continuous morphogenesis of bodies, melting one into another. The result is a series of spectral, post-natural entities that resist resolution, existing in a liminal zone between memory and matter, incarnated information [Ribeiro, 2021] interplaying potentiality and actuality.

As an expanded iteration of previous experimental endeavors, the work aligns with SIGGRAPH Asia 2025 Art Gallery theme *Generative Futures: Continuous Becoming*, foregrounding the unpredictable aesthetics and ontological indeterminacy of generative systems. It simultaneously provokes reflection on the ethics of deploying AI to process environmental disasters. The bizarre logic of generative AI aesthetics—marked by hallucinated forms, blurred textures, melted boundaries, and indeterminate shapes—serves as a critical dialogue with the visual and biological trauma of wildfire destruction. The dramatic abstraction of the generative outputs mirrors the devastation wrought by wildfires, while Ecovotive Chimeras critically engages with the ethics of aestheticizing catastrophe through artificial intelligence, reclaiming it as a poetic medium for ritual remembrance. The project begins not with an image but with a query—typed into Google’s search bar—a few words such as burned animals in Australia wildfires, carbonized wildlife in the Pantanal, or wildfire victims in California, Portugal, Greece, Slovenia, and so on. Each phrase initiates a real-time negotiation with one of the most powerful algorithmic systems of our time, one designed not merely to retrieve but to rank, filter, and anticipate human intent. The original images of carbonized wild animals are merged using the AI tool Krea, which generates a 10-second video from five input images. Frames from this video are then extracted and used as input for Meshy, another AI application that produces 3D models of hybrid, in-between creatures, then printed using a Bambu Lab A1 mini.



Figure 1: 3D-printed models generated from .stl files exported from Meshy.AI, based on extracted frames of generative AI animations created in Krea.AI. [Photography by the author].

3 final considerations

The project is presented as a contemplative, multi-sensory installation that unfolds gradually through physical interaction and augmented reality engagement. The work invites audiences to spend time with fifteen chimeric entities, arranged side by side on a tabletop. Visitors are encouraged to observe their material details, hold them gently, and scan each piece with a mobile device to activate embedded AR animations. These generative AI sequences visualize the morphogenesis of carbonized bodies melting into one another, evoking reflection on ecological grief and entangled agency.

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